Irini Amanaki
irini.amanaki@nyu.edu
10 Washington Place New York, NY 10003

Education

2025 – New York University, Ph.D. in Linguistics

2020 – 2024 University of Crete, Master's Program in Linguistics (GPA: 9.59/10)
Thesis title: *The development of wishes in child Greek*
Supervisor: Vina Tsakali

2015 – 2020 University of Crete, Bachelors of Philology (GPA 8.88/10)
Specialization: Linguistics

2018 University of Amsterdam, Erasmus + exchange student
Courses attended: Neurolinguistics, Philosophy of Mathematics, Evil in Thought and Literature, Stylistics

Further Education

Summer Schools

2024 6th Crete Summer School of Linguistics (*CreteLing2024*)
University of Crete

2023 5th CreteLing**,** Crete Summer School of Linguistics (*CreteLing2023*)
University of Crete

2022 4th CreteLing**,** Crete Summer School of Linguistics (*CreteLing2022*)
University of Crete

2022 V-NYI #5, Virtual Summer School in Linguistics, Cognition and Culture
NY-St. Petersburg Institute of Linguistics, Cognition and Culture (NYI)

2021 V-NYI #3, Virtual Summer School in Linguistics, Cognition and Culture
NY-St. Petersburg Institute of Linguistics, Cognition and Culture (NYI)

2019 3rd CreteLing**,** Crete Summer School of Linguistics (*CreteLing2019*)
University of Crete

2018 2nd CreteLing**,** Crete Summer School of Linguistics (*CreteLing2018*)
University of Crete

2017 1st CreteLing**,** Crete Summer School of Linguistics (*CreteLing2017*)
University of Crete

Online Education

2022 *Special Needs Education*, Training and Lifelong Learning Center of the University of Macedonia

2021 *Storytelling for Social Change*, MichiganX - Storytelling101x, Edx

2020 *PredictionX: Omens, Oracles & Prophecies*, HarvardX: SOC1.practx, Edx

Workshop

2024 *OLIVE-R: Open Linguistic Investigation and Variable Exploration with R*. Instructor: Onur Özsoy. In the context of the research project Directive Speech Acts in child and adult language: The role of form and prosody (DireSpeech).

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistantship in Linguistics

New York University

2026 (Spring) LING-PSYCH-UA 59 First Language Acquisition
Instructor: Ailís Cournane

University of Crete

2022 (Fall) GLOF165 Introduction to Syntax
Instructor: Elena Anagnostopoulou
2022 (Spring) GLOF175 Levels of Grammar
Instructor: Vina Tsakali
2022 (Spring) GLOF211 Minimalist Syntax
Instructor: Elena Anagnostopoulou
2021 (Fall) GLOF165 Introduction to Syntax
Instructor: Elena Anagnostopoulou
2021 (Spring) GLOF175 Levels of Grammar
Instructor: Vina Tsakali
2021 (Spring) GLOF111 Syntax II
Instructor: Elena Anagnostopoulou

Teaching Internship

02 – 06.2019 Teaching Intern at the Experimental Junior High School of Heraklion
Final project*: Teaching compounding in Modern Greek through Music*

Voluntary Tutoring

2016 – 2020 Voluntary tutor for primary and secondary school students
2016 Voluntary Syntax tutor for undergraduate students

Research experience and service

Research Experience

New York University

10.2025-04.2026 Graduate Research Assistant of Prof. Ailis Cournane. Job description: Stimuli creation for a language acquisition study involving working with Adobe Draw on the lab iPad.

University of Milan – Bicocca

01 – 04. 2025 Erasmus + Intern at the University of Milan – Bicocca. Main project: The acquisition of the mental attitude verbs *know* and *think:* literature review and experimental design. Advisor: Maria Teresa Guasti.
Other duties: (1) image generation for a language acquisition project, (2) translation to Greek and recording of the testing sentences of the Leibnizdream – H06 Relative Clause study, (3) study and summary of language acquisition papers.

University of Crete

03 – 05. 2024 Research Assistant in *DireSpeech* Research project: *Interpreting*

Directive Speech Acts in child and adult language: The role of form and Prosody. Principal Investigator: Despina Oikonomou. University of Crete. (website)

05 – 11. 2023 Research Assistant in *VarIphon* Research project: *Variation, input frequency and norm in the phonological development of Greek as first Language (L1)*. Principal Investigator: Ioanna Kappa. University of Crete. (website)

Academic Service

2026 – 2027 Co-secretary (with Jonathan Merchan) of the Linguistics Association @ NYU (LANYU).

2017 – 2024 Volunteer for CreteLing Summer School, CreteLing2017-CreteLing2024: assistantship to the Organizing Committee.

2023 & 2024 Dorm master (Xenia Dorms) in CreteLing 2023 and CreteLing2024.

2024 Language consultant (as a native speaker of Greek) for a questionnaire study on modality in the project "Logic in Semantic Universals" at the University of Edinburgh: Uegaki, Wataru & Mucha, Anne & Hannon, Ella & Engels, James & Whibley, Fred. 2024. Cross-linguistic dataset of force-flavor combinations in modal elements. *Linguistic Variation.* here

2023 Member of the voluntary student group for the Computational Phylogenetics and language (Pre)history Workshop: Achievements, Challenges and Prospects, 23 – 25 May 2023, University of Crete.

2022 Member of the organizing committee for the Working on Linguistics2@UoC workshop (Workshop for the original work of the graduate students at the University of Crete).

2020 Participation in the human annotation experiment for: Aditi Chaudhary, Antonios Anastasopoulos, Zaid Sheikh, Graham Neubig. 2021. Reducing Confusion in Active Learning for Part-Of-Speech Tagging. Transactions of the Association for Computational Linguistics; 9 1–16. here

Publications

2025 Oikonomou, D., Tsakali, V. P., Gatsou, M., Vassileiou, B., Kaniadaki, M., Karatzanou, D., & Amanaki, I. (2025). Fantasy Play and the Language of Emplotment in Greek L1 Children. In *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society* (Vol. 47). here

2025 Amanaki Irini & Vina Tsakali. ''I wish I was blue!': The development of (un)attainable desires in child Greek'. *In the Proceedings of the 49th Annual Boston University Conference on Language Development* (BUCLD49), November 7-10, 2024, Boston University. here

To appear Amanaki Irini. '*Orea* as a case of language change in Modern Greek'. 1st Workshop for graduate students at the University of Crete, Working on Linguistics1@UoC. University of Crete.

2024 Tsakali, Vina & Irini Amanaki. 'Simple and Directive Subjunctive Conditionals in Child Greek'. In the *Proceedings of the 48th Annual Boston University Conference on Language Development* (BUCLD48), edited by Hayat Abdullah Ali and Jupitara Ray, pp. 638-648. here

2024 Ploumidi, Eirini, Ioanna Kappa, Eirini Amanaki, & Eirini Giannikouri. 'Studying phonological acquisition: Data collection method'. In Dimitris Michelioudakis, Alexandros Tantos, & Konstantina Tsiousia (Eds.), *Studies in Greek Linguistics 43* (pp. 505-514). Institute of Modern Greek Studies (Manolis Triandaphyllidis Foundation).

2022 Amanaki, E., Bernardy, J-P., Chatzikyriakidis, St., Cooper, R., Dobnik, S., Karimi, A., Ek, A., Giannikouri, E.C., Katsouli, V., Kolokousis, I., Mamatzaki, E.C., Papadakis, D., Petrova, O., Psaltaki, E., Skoulataki, E., Soupiona, Ch., Stefanidou, Chr.. 'Fine-grained Entailment: Resources for Greek and Precise Entailment'. *Proceedings of the Workshop on Dataset Creation for Lower Resourced Languages within the 13th Language Resources and Evaluation Conference*, DCLRL 2022. here

Presentations

06.10.2026 Despina Oikonomou, Vina Tsakali, Mary Baltazani, Katerina Iliopoulou, Irini Amanaki, Manuela Genitsaridi, Mary Kaniadaki, Danae Karatzanou, Marina Mastrokosta. *Distinguishing between request and permission in directives: Children's acquisition of lexical and prosodic cues.* Talk at Experiments in Linguistics Meaning Conference (ELM 4), at UPenn, Philadelphia.

30.10.2025 Irini Amanaki. *The development of desires in child language.* Presentation at Conceptual Development and Social Cognition Lab Rhodes. Department of Psychology, New York University, New York.

25.10.2025 Irini Amanaki. *'I want! I want!': The development of (un)attainable desires in child Greek. P*resentation at LAWNE workshop. Yale University, New Haven.

23.09.2025 Oikonomou, Despina, Vina Tsakali, Maria Gatsou, Katerina Iliopoulou, Vasiliou, Irini Amanaki, Mary Kaniadaki, Danae Karatzanou. *'Grammar in fantasy play in L1-Greek Child Speech'.* Talk at the 17th International Conference on Greek Linguistics (ICGL), 23-26 September 2025, University of Cambridge, U.K.

02.08.2025 Despina Oikonomou, Vina Tsakali, Maria Gatsou, Benedict Vassileiou, Mary Kaniadaki, Danai Karatzanou & Irini Amanaki. *'Fantasy Play and the Language of Emplotment in Greek L1 Children'.* Poster presentation in CogSci 2025 Conference, San Francisco, CA.

04.05.2025 Vina Tsakali, Despina Oikonomou, Maria Gatsou, Katerina Iliopoulou, Benedict Vassileiou, Marina Mastrokosta, Mary Kaniadaki, Danae Karatzanou & Irini Amanaki. '*The development of Mood and Aspect in Greek Directive Speech Acts*'. AMGL45, May 2-4, 2025, Aristotle University, Thessaloniki.

09.11.2024 Amanaki Irini & Vina Tsakali*. ''I wish I was blue!': The development of (un)attainable desires in child Greek'.* Poster presentation. 49th Annual

Boston University Conference on Language Development (BUCLD49), November 7-10, 2024, Boston University.

13.09.2024 Tsakali Vina, Despina Oikonomou & Irini Amanaki. 'Conditional reasoning in teleological directives in Greek: Evidence from child language'. Poster presentation. 16th Generative Approaches to Language Acquisition (GALA) Conference, September 12-14, 2024, NOVA University of Lisbon – School of Social Sciences and Humanities (NOVA FCSH).

22.07.2024 Amanaki Irini & Vina Tsakali. 'The development of desires and wishes in child Greek'. Poster presentation. 6th Crete Summer School of Linguistics, CreteLing, July 13-26 2024, University of Crete.

04.11.2023 Tsakali Vina & Irini Amanaki. 'Simple and Subjunctives Conditionals in child Greek'. Poster presentation. 48th Annual Boston University Conference on Language Development (BUCLD48), November 2-5, 2023, Boston University.

20.07.2023 Tsakali Vina & Irini Amanaki. 'Child comprehension of Simple Conditionals and Directive Subjunctives'. Poster presentation. 5th Crete Summer School of Linguistics, CreteLing. July 15-28, 2023, University of Crete.

05.05.2023 Tsakali Vina & Irini Amanaki, 'The development of If-future clauses and Subjunctive Conditionals in Greek'. 43rd Annual Meeting of the Department of Linguistics. May 4-7, 2023, Aristotle University of Thessaloniki.

05.05.2023 Ploumidi Eirini, Ioanna Kappa, Eirini Amanaki, Ioanna Chrisoulaki, Eirini Giannikouri, Maria Kanli, Maria Karouzou-Mathioudaki, Vasiliki Katsouli, Christina Mousga, Ilia Nikoloudaki & Dimitris Papadakis. 'Studying phonological acquisition: Collecting longitudinal data that result in fine-grained research findings'. 43rd Annual Meeting of the Department of Linguistics. May 4-7, 2023, Aristotle University of Thessaloniki.

24.06.2022 Amanaki, E., Bernardy, J-P., Chatzikyriakidis, St., Cooper, R., Dobnik, S., Karimi, A., Ek, A., Giannikouri, E.C., Katsouli, V., Kolokousis, I., Mamatzaki, E.C., Papadakis, D., Petrova, O., Psaltaki, E., Skoulataki, E., Soupiona, Ch., Stefanidou, Chr.. 'Fine-grained Entailment: Resources for Greek and Precise Entailment'. Workshop on Dataset Creation for Lower Resourced Languages (LREC) within the 13th Language Resources and Evaluation Conference (DCLRL).

24.09.2021 Amanaki Irini. 'Orea as a case of language change and grammaticalization in Modern Greek'. 1st Workshop for graduate students at the University of Crete, Working on Linguistics1@UoC, September 24, 2021, University of Crete.

Awards

2025	New York University's Graduate School of Arts and Science MacCracken Award (5-year Fellowship).
2020	Certification for being the highest-ranked student among the graduates of the School of Philosophy in 2019 – 2020, University of Crete.

Skills

Languages	Greek (native), English (proficient), German (intermediate), Spanish (beginner), Ancient Greek (reading knowledge)
Technical	PCIbex - open-source online experiment builder ELAN - linguistic annotator LaTeX R (beginner)
Music	Konnakol, playing the bendir/ frame drum

Further Interests

2026	**Performance as a way of investigating identity.** Participant at the Workshop: *Performing Narratives | Performing Personal Narratives ME AND YOU - Performance as a Way of Knowing.* NYU Tisch School of the Arts. New York. Instructor: Anna Deavere Smith (website)
2023 - 2025	**Learning about folk Mediterranean music and its history.** Member of the amateur vocal group *'Cojam'*. Heraklion, Crete. Instructor: Maria Koti.
2021 – 2023	**Music curation and storytelling through the radio.** Amateur radio producer at Owlradio.gr (website)
2019 – 2023	**Exploring rhythm through percussion and using it as a tool for education**. Participant in the program Rhythm4edu and volunteer instructor for the warm-up exercises during Covid-19 through the platform https://rhythm4edu.coursevo.com/. Rethimnon and Heraklion, Crete. Instructors: Yiannis Papatzanis, Anthi Fourki.
2019 – 2020	**Hiking**. Volunteer in the student hiking group *"Propato stin Kriti".* Rethimnon, Crete.